Student Roll Number: _____ Student Name: _____

Activity

Generate Ideas: Recycling Business Concepts

1. Spend a day searching the internet to find stories of entrepreneurs who started interesting businesses that are located in another country. Some good websites to begin with are:
   http://www.businessinsider.com/
   http://www.entrepreneur.com/
   http://www.google.com/
   http://www.businessesforsale.com/
2. As you read an article about each small business ask yourself some questions:
   - What is the primary need this company appears to be trying to fill?
   - Would the people in my community likely have a similar need for this type of business and could I introduce something similar locally?

   If the answers are "yes" then document the business concepts below:

Name of company # 1	City, country of headquarters:	Website
Business concept & need being filled: _____ _____ _____		
How I could improve this idea: _____ _____ _____		

3. Another approach is to call a member of the family or a friend located far away and asks them if they know of any innovative or note-worthy businesses near where they live. Or if you are going to university far from home you can always just walk around town and see if there are any local businesses worth emulating back at home. Either way, write down a few notes about each idea so you can add these new business concepts to the interesting ones you learned about via the internet.

4. Repeat step 2 as you read articles or hear about other small businesses:
   - What is the primary need this additional company appears to be trying to fill?
   - Would the people in my community likely have a similar need for this type of business and could I introduce something similar locally? If answer is "yes" then document the business concept below.

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Name of company # 2	City, country of headquarters:	Website
Business concept & need being filled: _____ _____ _____		
How I could improve this idea: _____ _____ _____		

5. Repeat this process in the spaces that follow:

Name of company # 3	City, country of headquarters:	Website
Business concept & need being filled: _____ _____ _____		
How I could improve this idea: _____ _____ _____		

Name of company # 4	City, country of headquarters:	Website
Business concept & need being filled: _____ _____ _____		
How I could improve this idea: _____ _____ _____		

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Name of company # 5	City, country of headquarters:	Website
Business concept & need being filled: _____ _____ _____		
How I could improve this idea: _____ _____ _____		

6. Review the business concepts listed above and circle the top concepts that you feel are most interesting and promising.

If you'd like to generate more business ideas then you may want to try:

- Combining two of your existing ideas together to create an interesting new idea
- Analyzing an industry that is rapidly growing or that you find interesting to seek what problems people in this industry may be facing and what opportunities may exist to solve these problems
- Re doing any of the four strategies already reviewed in this packet to generate even more ides

Home Task 1

Listing of ideas that you are interested

The key aim of this assignment is to generate at least 5 ideas that interest you. You should try to identify gaps and weaknesses in existing products/services available in the market. You can also observe your community of residence and think about key challenges or issues which your community is facing daily. After generating ideas of your interest, enlist them into the given template.

Name: _____ **Roll # & Section: _____**

Enlist your ideas

Student Roll Number: _____ Student Name: _____

How to Quickly Evaluate Ideas

After you generate a good number of new business ideas you will need to determine which ideas are most promising and which ideas to cross off.

1. For each of the best business ideas you generated, write each idea in the BUSINESS IDEA sections of the following pages (one idea per section). This will make it easier to evaluate each idea quickly.
2. In the section below, write your answers clearly and concisely to the three key questions listed about your business idea.

BUSINESS IDEA # 1 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences:	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met:	
b) Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.)	
c) Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why:	
Total Score (a+b+c)	

3. The rate of your answers from 1-10 in the "Rate each answer from 1-10" column on the right. An Outstanding idea with a compelling need should be rated a 10, an idea with a clearly defined target market should be rated a 10, and an incredibly interesting and exciting idea should be rated a 10. Anything less should be rated lower. A rating of 1 is the lowest rating. Most answers will likely fall in between and should be rated accordingly. So, rate each answer listed above.
4. Add your three ratings together to comprise your total score (maximum total is 30) which you should write in the shaded TOTAL SCORE section above for future comparison.

BUSINESS IDEA # 2 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences:	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a) What is the compelling need that is not currently being met:	
b)Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) :	
c)Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why:	
Total Score (a+b+c)	

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BUSINESS IDEA # 3 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences:	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a)What is the compelling need that is not currently being met:	
b)Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) :	
c)Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why:	
Total Score (a+b+c)	
BUSINESS IDEA # 4 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences:	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a)What is the compelling need that is not currently being met:	
b)Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) :	
c)Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why:	
Total Score (a+b+c)	
BUSINESS IDEA # 5 – Clearly describe the idea in a few sentences:	Rate Each answer from 1-10
a)What is the compelling need that is not currently being met:	
b)Who is the target market that has this need (demographics, characteristics, etc.) :	
c)Does this idea sound interesting and exciting to me, if so, why:	
Total Score (a+b+c)	

Generating and Screening Ideas

Step 1: Expand your list if possible: As you have already developed a list of 5 ideas according to your interest. Now think about your personal interests, your desired lifestyle, your values, what you feel you are likely to do very well, and contributions you would like to make.

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Step 2: Ask at least three people who know you well to look at your list, and revise your list to reflect any new ideas emerging from this exchange.

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Step 3: Jot down insights, observations, and conclusions that have emerged about your business ideas or your personal preferences. Which ones solve the greatest pain point/aggravation/frustration for which you (and others you have spoken with) would pay a significant premium to eliminate?

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